

Normal family of analytic functions

Defn: Let U be a nonempty open subset of $\mathbb{C}$, and let $g_k: U \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, $k=1,2,\dots$, be a family of complex analytic functions. The family $\{g_k\}$ is said to be normal on U if every sequence of functions selected from $\{g_k\}$ has a subsequence that converges uniformly on every compact subset of U , either to a bounded analytic function or to ∞ .

The family $\{g_k\}$ is normal at a point $w \in \mathbb{C}$ if $\exists$ an open set U containing w such that $\{g_k\}$ is normal on U .

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Montel's theorem:

Let $\{g_k\}$ be a family of complex analytic functions on an open domain U . If $\{g_k\}$ is not a normal family, then for all $w \in \mathbb{C}$ with at most one exception $g_k(z)=w$ for some $z \in U$ and for some k .

Using the Montel's theorem, we get the following characterization of Julia sets.

Theorem: $J(f) = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : \text{the family } \{f^k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}} \text{ is not normal at } z\}$.

Proof: Let $z \in J(f)$. Then $\{f^k(z)\}$ is bounded.

Also, in any neighborhood V of z , $\exists w \in V$ s.t. $f^k(w) \rightarrow \infty$.

$\Rightarrow \{f^k\}$ is not normal on V .

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Suppose $z \notin J(f)$.
 Then either $z \in \text{int } K(f)$ or $z \in \mathbb{C} \setminus K(f)$.
 If $z \in \text{int } K(f)$, then $\exists$ an open set V s.t.
 $z \in V \subseteq \text{int } K(f)$
 Then for all $w \in V$, $f^k(w) \in K(f) \forall k \in \mathbb{N}$.
 $\Rightarrow \{f^k\}$ is normal at z (by Montel's theorem)
 If $z \in \mathbb{C} \setminus K(f)$, $|f^k(z)| > \gamma$ for some k ,
 where γ is as in the previous lemma.
 $\Rightarrow |f^k(w)| > \gamma \forall w$ is some neighbourhood V
 of z (by continuity of f^k)
 $\Rightarrow f^k \rightarrow \infty$ uniformly on V .
 $\Rightarrow \{f^k\}$ is normal at z .
 $\therefore$ If $\{f^k\}$ is not normal at z , $z \in J(f)$

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Lemma: Let f be a polynomial of degree ≥ 2 .
 Let $w \in J(f)$ and let U be any neighborhood of w .
 Then, for each $j \in \mathbb{N}$, the sets
 $W = \bigcup_{k=j}^{\infty} f^k(U)$
 is the whole of $\mathbb{C}$, except possibly for a single point. Any such exceptional point is not in $J(f)$, and is independent of w and U .
Proof: Since $w \in J(f)$, by the previous theorem,
 the family $\{f^k\}_{k=j}^{\infty}$ is not normal at w .
 Then Montel's theorem says that W is
 the whole of $\mathbb{C}$, except possibly a single point.

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Suppose $v \notin W$.
 We have to show that $v \notin J(f)$.
 For this we'll show that the family
 $\{f^k\}$ is normal at v .

Let $f(z) = v$ for some $z \in \mathbb{C}$.
 Then $z \notin W$ (because $f(W) \subseteq W$ & $v \notin W$)

Since, $C \setminus W$ has at most one point,
 $z = v$.

$\Rightarrow f(z) - v$ is a polynomial of degree n
 having $z = v$ as the only root.

$\Rightarrow f(z) - v = c(z-v)^n$ for some constant c .

If z is sufficiently close to v , then
 $f^k(z) - v \rightarrow 0$ as $k \rightarrow \infty$,

the convergence is uniform on $\{z: |z-v| < (4c)^{-\frac{1}{n-1}}\}$

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$\Rightarrow \{f^k\}$ is normal at v .

$\Rightarrow v \notin J(f)$.

Clearly, v only depends on the polynomial f .

Corollary:

(a) The following holds for all $z \in \mathbb{C}$ with at most one exception: if U is an open set that intersects $J(f)$ then $f^k(z)$ intersects U for infinitely many values of k .

If there is an exceptional point z , $z \notin J(f)$.

(b) If $z \in J(f)$, then $J(f)$ is the closure of $\bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} f^k(z)$.

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Proof:

(a) Let $z \in \mathbb{C}$ be such that it is not the exceptional point in the previous lemma.
Then $z \in f^k(U)$ for some $k \geq j$.

$$\Rightarrow f^k(z) \cap U \neq \emptyset.$$

(b) If $z \in J(f)$, then $f^k(z) \subseteq J(f)$ ($\because f(J) \subseteq J$)

$$\Rightarrow \bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} f^k(z) \subseteq J(f)$$

$$\text{Since } J(f) \text{ is closed, } \overline{\bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} f^k(z)} \subseteq J(f)$$

Also, if $z \in J(f)$ and U is any open set containing z , then $f^k(z) \cap U \neq \emptyset$ for some k by (a).

$$\therefore z \in \overline{\bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} f^k(z)}.$$

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